

Card Reader Troubleshooting Guide

Toast POS — Store Manager Reference

Toast credit card readers are essential for payment processing. This guide helps store staff diagnose and resolve common card reader issues to minimize downtime.

1. Initial Checks

Start by identifying the nature of the issue:

- Device not powering on — no lights or indicators on the reader
- Connection issues — reader not detected by the POS system
- Card processing errors — transactions failing or cards not being read
- Physical damage — signs of wear on the reader, cable, or ports

Gather the following information before troubleshooting:

- When did the issue start?
- Has there been a recent system update or hardware change?
- Does the issue occur consistently or randomly?

2. Troubleshooting Steps

- Reboot Terminal: Power off the terminal, wait a few seconds, then power back on.
- Reboot Card Reader: Unplug the reader, wait 30 seconds, and reconnect.
- Check for Damage: Inspect the USB cable and port for visible damage. Replace if necessary.
- Software Update: Ensure Toast POS software is up to date. Hold and release the power button to display update options if available.

3. Testing the Reader

- Run a test transaction to verify the reader is functioning correctly.

4. Escalation Protocol

If the issue persists after completing the above steps:

- Submit a support ticket via your internal ticketing system. Include: store number, register number, and a photo of the issue.
- If after hours, contact Toast Customer Care (available 24/7).